

VIRGINIA SPACEPORT AUTHORITY · LIVE TRAINING

Microsoft 365 Copilot at Work

Making Copilot work for you.

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SESSION A · 60 MINUTES

Prompting & Copilot Chat

Get real answers from your own documents - reliably.





SESSION A · THE SCENARIO

Monday at the spaceport

Campaign MERIDIAN is two weeks from its window. The reading pile doesn't care.



48-page safety policy - updated Friday - you must know what changed



Ops status report - leadership wants the short version



90 minutes - before your next meeting

What is Microsoft 365 Copilot?

Three ideas, and the rest of the hour makes sense.



AI + your content

A language model reasons over your prompt plus the documents you give it.



Inside your apps

Chat, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, OneNote
- where you already work.



Directed in English

No syntax. You describe the outcome; it drafts, you decide.

What can Copilot do for you?



Generate

Drafts, emails, briefs - and images too. Blank page, gone.



Summarize

48 pages into 5 bullets. Long threads into decisions.



Compare

Two versions, three proposals, old policy vs new - side by side.



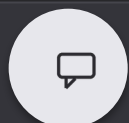
Analyze

A spreadsheet becomes insights, outliers, and formulas.



Rewrite

Same content, new audience: shorter, simpler, more formal.



Answer

Ask questions about YOUR documents - with citations.



SESSION A · THE APP

Meet the Copilot app - home base

One app, three doors. Same Copilot behind all of them.



On the web - m365.cloud.microsoft - works everywhere



Inside Teams - the Copilot app in your left rail



On Windows - the Microsoft 365 Copilot app

The prompt box - your cockpit



The + button

Attach files - your grounding superpower. Word, Excel, PDFs.



Suggestion chips

Files, Emails, People, Meetings - one-tap starting points as rollout matures.



Just type

Plain language. No syntax, no commands to memorize.



New chat, new topic

One conversation per task keeps answers sharp.

Effective Copilot use - in and out



Quality in

- Ask with all four GCSE elements
- Ground it - give it your sources
- Iterate - refine in conversation



Vetted out

- Verify receipts and numbers
- Traffic-light before you act
- You own everything you send



This slide is the whole hour: the first half teaches quality in, the back half teaches vetted out.

The four elements · G C S E

Every strong prompt has these. Weak prompts are missing one.



Goal

The deliverable. 'Draft a one-page leadership brief.'



Context

Who it's for, why now. 'For the executive director, pre-launch.'



Source

Ground it - attach the file. 'Using the attached status report.'



Expectations

Format, length, tone. 'Five bullets, plain language, no jargon.'

Simple to best - add one at a time

01

Goal

'Summarize the new safety policy.'

>

02

+ Context

'...for ops staff who knew the old one.'

>

03

+ Source

'...using the attached policy document.'

>

04

+ Expectation

'5.5 bullets on what changed, plain language.'

Iterate - don't start over



Re-aim it

'Rewrite this for the executive director, not ops staff.'



Restructure it

'Reorganize as: summary, 3 changes, risks, effective dates.'



Cut it

'Keep only the top 3 items by operational impact.'



Tighten it

'Remove any sentence without a decision, number, or action.'

Your chats stick around



Pick up where you left

Yesterday's thread is in the left rail - continue it, don't restart.



Name the keepers

Rename chats you'll return to: 'Budget prep', 'Policy questions'.



Context carries

Follow-ups remember the conversation - iterate without re-explaining.

Pick your speed



Auto

The default. Copilot picks the right engine for the task - leave it here.



Quick response

Fast answers for simple asks - summaries, rewrites, lookups.



Think Deeper

Slower, stronger reasoning - comparisons, risk analysis, hard tradeoffs.



Don't see the picker? It's rolling out - Auto behavior is the default either way.

Grounding - give Copilot the fuel



Answers mix four sources

What the model knows, what it can reach, what you hand it, and the web. Grounding is choosing well.



What the model knows

Built-in general knowledge. Fine for common ground - a fabrication risk for YOUR facts and figures.



OneDrive & SharePoint

Files stored there are reachable sources - point Copilot at them.



Attach file(s)

The surest ground: Copilot reads every word of what you give it. This move powers everything today.



Your content, not the open web

Web results are off in your environment - your documents carry the day, and uploads cover the rest.



One habit, five apps - the attach move works in Chat, Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook.

How Copilot builds an answer

01

Your prompt

You ask in plain language inside the app.



02

It grounds

It reads the files you attached or opened.



03

You review

You get a draft - check it, then decide.

Grounding and the receipt



Your permissions

Copilot only sees what you can already open. Nothing more.



Citations

Grounded answers point at their source. Click it. Check it.



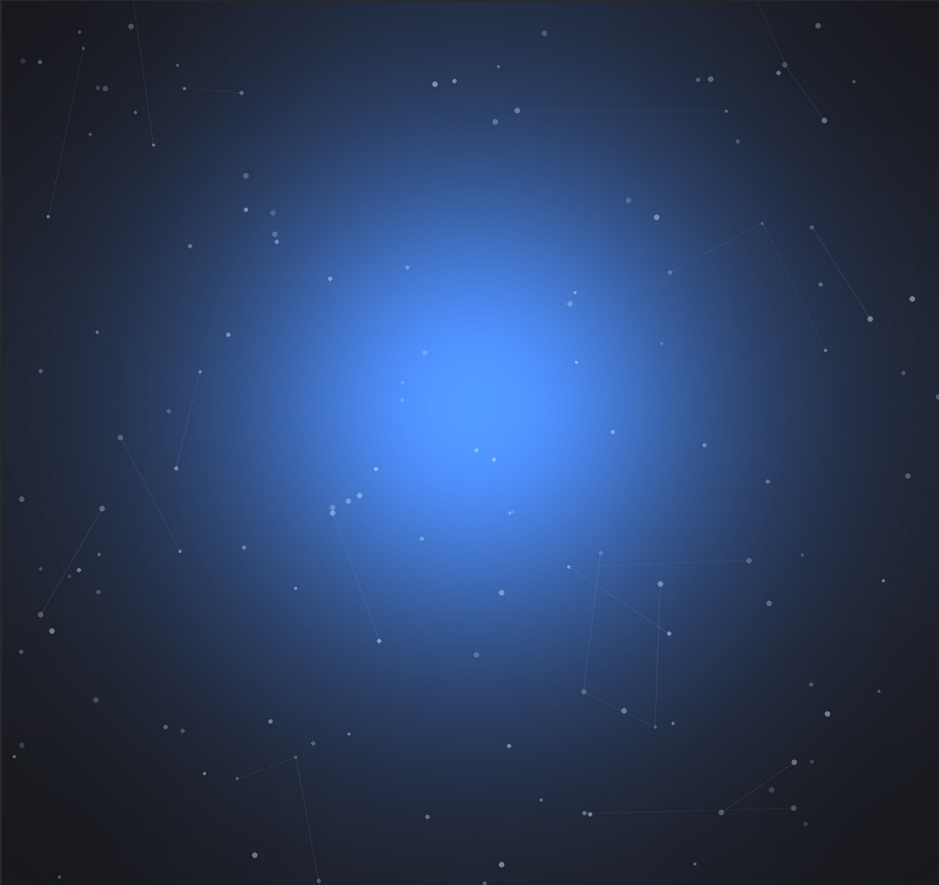
Verify the claim

Numbers, names, dates - confirm against the document before it leaves you.



Treat every output as a first draft from a fast, confident junior analyst.

48 pages to 5 bullets - with receipts



LIVE DEMO

- 1** Level-1 prompt, then build to full GCSE
- 2** Click a citation - verify against the page
- 3** Follow-up: launch-day staffing question
- 4** KEEP IT: bookmark the prompt · send to a Page

Keep the prompt - the Gallery



Open it

New chat, then the ... under the message box - proven prompts by task and role.



Save your winners

Hover over a prompt you've already run - click the bookmark icon. Kept.



Share the team's

One person's discovery becomes everyone's speed.

Create - the design studio



Images from words

Describe it: an image, infographic, poster, or banner
- refine in conversation.



Edit an image

Bring one you have; change it by describing the change.



My images

Everything you've generated, collected right here under Create.



Generated images live here under My images - not in Library. Library is for Pages.

Find it again: Search vs Library



Search

- Hunt across your chats
- Find that answer from last week
- Reach your work content



Library

- Your Pages in one place
- Living documents - edit and share
- Reopen and continue any Page



A great answer deserves promotion: send it to a Page - editable, shareable, alive.

Agents & Notebooks - a look ahead



Researcher

Deep multi-step research over your content - assign it a question, get a report.



Analyst

Data analysis in chat - reads your spreadsheets, reasons about numbers.



Notebooks

Pin a project's sources; Copilot answers from only those files.



Availability follows your license and rollout - when these light up, today's prompting skills drive them.

Validate before you ship - 4 checks

01

The receipt

Open a citation;
confirm it
matches.



02

The numbers

Figures, names,
dates vs source.



03

The sources

'List your source
per claim.'



04

The gaps

'What does this
leave out?'

Three tells worth a second look



Suspiciously round

Numbers that feel too clean - verify against the source table.



Receipt won't click

A citation that doesn't open or doesn't match - stop and check.



Beyond the document

Claims about things your attached file never mentions - ask where it came from.

The traffic light - then act



Green - use it

Receipts click, numbers match, nothing invented. Ship it.



Yellow - adjust

Right shape, soft spots. Fix the prompt - usually add Source - and re-run.



Red - re-ground

Claims beyond the document or receipts that don't hold. Start a fresh, grounded ask.



Most yellows are a missing Source. Attach the file and the light usually turns green.

Paste these to pressure-test

What you're practicing

- Make Copilot show its work
- Anchor every claim to the document
- Surface its own uncertainty
- Hunt the gaps before your reader does

PASTE THIS

“

List your source for each claim in that answer - one line per claim.

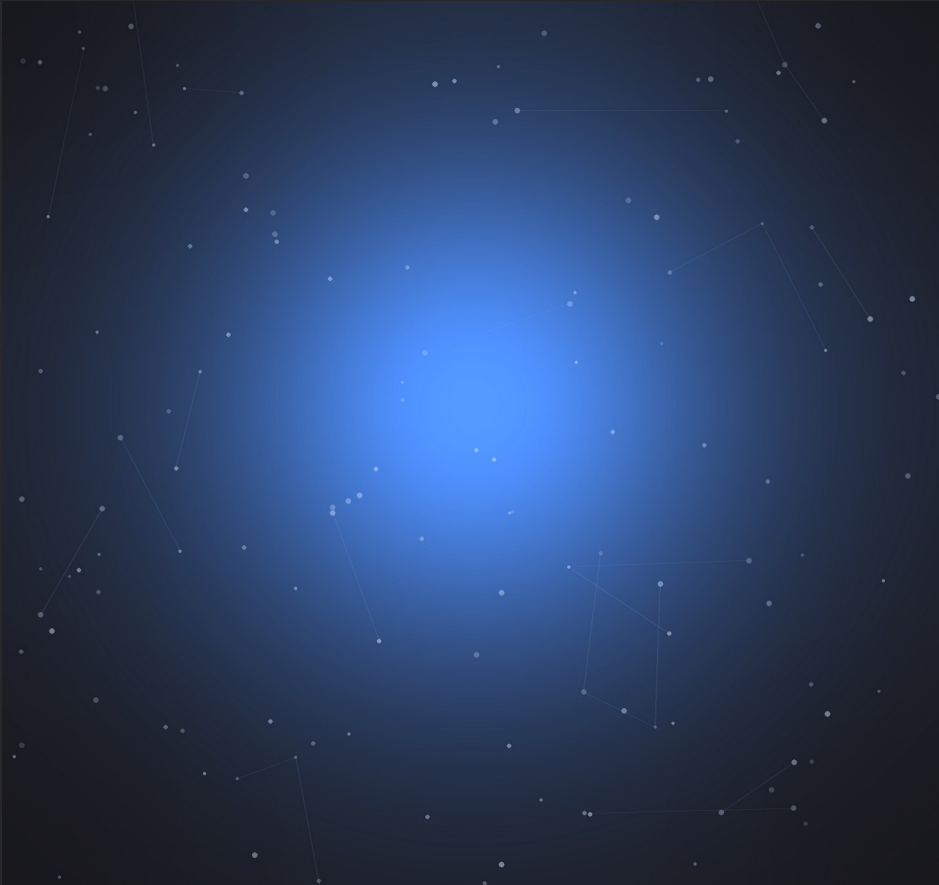
“

Quote the exact sentence from the attached document that supports [claim].

“

What in this answer are you least confident about, and why?

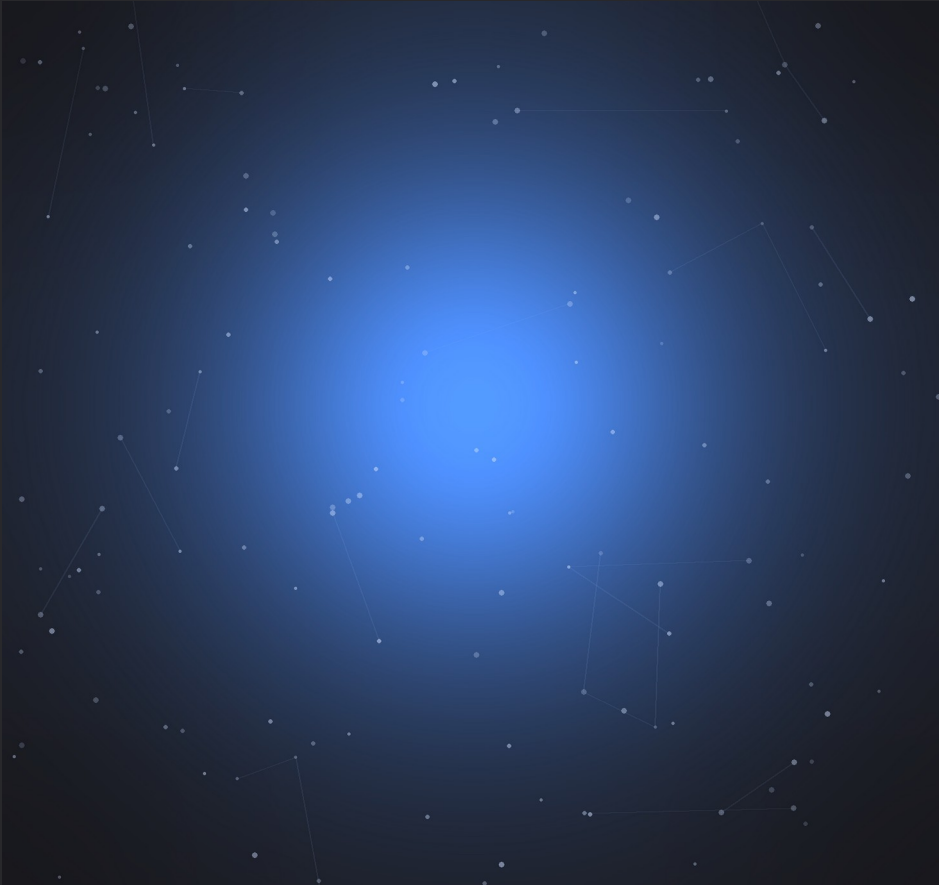
Break it on purpose - then catch it



LIVE DEMO

- 1** Ask the policy doc something it never covers
- 2** Watch the answer - honest gap or confident guess?
- 3** Demand the quote: 'exact sentence, please'
- 4** Re-ground and re-ask - watch it self-correct

Status report to leadership brief



LIVE DEMO

- 1** Attach Launch_Campaign_Status.docx
- 2** Full GCSE prompt - one-page leadership brief
- 3** Iterate: re-aim to the board, then cut to 3 items
- 4** Tighten: decisions, numbers, actions only

Paste these into Copilot Chat

What you're practicing

- Attach the file - always
- Name the audience and format
- Iterate with the four verbs
- Verify one citation every time

PASTE THIS

“

Summarize the attached [policy/report] for [audience]: 5 bullets on what changed, plain language, include section numbers.

“

Using the attached report, draft a one-page brief for [leader]: progress, top 3 risks with owners, decisions needed this week.

“

Remove any sentence without a decision, a number, or an action.

Your take-home kit



The VSA Prompt Packet

Every prompt from today, 38 total, brackets for your own work.



Art & Science of Prompting

Microsoft's 2-page field guide: prompt types by task, and how to keep the conversation going.



Practice files + the story

Campaign MERIDIAN's documents - run any packet prompt against them.



All three: github.com/scottrhay/vsacopilot - drop the link in chat now.

Three moves the pros use



Borrow an expert voice

'Act as a range safety officer reviewing this...' - the persona sets depth, vocabulary and blind spots.



Let it interview you

'Interview me one question at a time to build the best prompt for [task].'



Self-critique

'Critique your answer and rewrite it better.' The second draft usually wins.



All three work in your environment today - no special features needed.

Borrow an expert voice - openers

Why personas work

- A role brings its vocabulary and depth
- Different experts catch different risks
- Stretch: review as your toughest reader
- Combine with GCSE - persona is Context

PASTE THIS

“

Act as a [range safety officer / contracts specialist / communications director].
Review the attached document and flag what your role would catch.

“

You are a skeptical executive reviewer.
What three questions would you ask before approving this?

Your first ten minutes



Three lines to keep

“

If it matters, attach the file.

“

GCSE: Goal, Context, Source, Expectations.

“

First answer is a draft - iterate, then verify.

Questions - and your first prompt

Before you log off

Pick ONE prompt from the packet and run it on a real document today. That's the whole assignment.

Coming up

Session B at 4:00 - Copilot in Teams & Outlook: your inbox, triaged.

APPENDIX

Your environment reference

The availability map - July 2026.



Use today - and what's next

USE TODAY	NOT YET AVAILABLE HERE
Chat with attached files	Enterprise-wide chat grounding
Word: grounded drafts, rewrites	PPT auto-create, speaker notes
PPT & Word: summarize, tighten	Teams: recap and chat Copilot
Outlook: summarize, draft, coach	Outlook: Schedule with Copilot
Excel: formulas, explain, what-if	Excel: Python and automation
OneNote: summaries, actions	Edge sidebar; web grounding